The Kansas-Nebraska Act

33rd Congress · May 30, 1854

Source: Kansas-Nebraska Act (1854). Public domain. The popular-sovereignty clause.

> Senator Stephen Douglas's act let settlers in Kansas and Nebraska decide slavery by “popular sovereignty,” repealing the Missouri Compromise line. It triggered a rush of pro- and anti-slavery settlers and the violence of “Bleeding Kansas.”

It being the true intent and meaning of this act not to legislate slavery into any Territory or State, nor to exclude it therefrom, but to leave the people thereof perfectly free to form and regulate their domestic institutions in their own way, subject only to the Constitution of the United States.